VIGIL

Operational intelligence that stays inside the country

YEAR	ROLE	TEAM	STATUS
2026	Product, architecture, engineering	Solo build	Public source

Summary

A sovereign operational-intelligence platform that models evidence, investigations and missions as a governed ontology, designed so that no prompt ever leaves South Africa.

The problem

Analysts working on sensitive investigations are often asked to choose between useful software and software that keeps their material in the country. Cloud-first tools make that choice for them. Vigil starts from the opposite assumption: the evidence stays where the work happens, and the model is a guest with no tools of its own.

The product models evidence, investigations and missions as one governed ontology. Every claim in the interface can be traced back to the record that supports it, and every consequential change is a command with an owner, a reason and an audit trail.

What is built

- A Java core and PostgreSQL record with idempotent, concurrency-checked commands.
- A Python intelligence service for extraction, planning and JSON-schema contracts, with optional local Ollama reasoner and challenger models.
- A Next.js cockpit for analysts, built around evidence and review rather than chat.
- A locally verifiable audit chain, evidence-linked plans and POPIA section 71 human-decision controls.
- Twelve architecture decision records and a 43-phase roadmap, published with the code.

Decisions that matter

Evidence before prose

Choice. Model proposals must quote exact evidence and pass analyst review before publication.

Why. A claim without a record behind it is not usable in an investigation.

Trade-off. The first answer is slower than a chat reply.

The model gets no tools

Choice. Untrusted material is fenced as data and the planner receives no tools.

Why. Instructions hidden in captured content cannot trigger an action.

Trade-off. The planner cannot fetch anything on its own.

Run inside the country

Choice. A local Ollama reasoner is supported end to end.

Why. Sensitive evidence and prompts stay in South Africa.

Trade-off. Smaller models and more operational work.

Stack

`Java` `Python` `TypeScript` `Next.js` `PostgreSQL` `Ollama`

Where to look

- Source on GitHub: https://github.com/konethegreat/Vigil
- Case study: konethegreat.github.io/work/vigil